

STOPS & ANTICIPATIONS

Where phrases land · How they arrive early

STOPS

The last note before silence. Stops reveal the hidden structure of a melody.

Find the stops in this melody:



Beat 1

Not a stop — beat 2 follows

Beat 2

Not a stop — and2 follows

Beat 3 ★

STOP — silence follows

And 4 ★

STOP — end of measure

Rule: Only the LAST note before a rest is a stop.

Stops are where phrases **LAND** — like the period at the end of a sentence.

Analyze where stops fall → discover the Rhythm Code hidden in any song.

ANTICIPATIONS

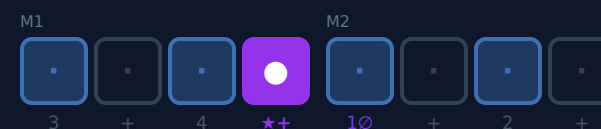
A stop on an upbeat with no note on the next downbeat. The note arrived early.

REGULAR — 1/8 NOTE EARLY



Arrived on "and 2." Beat 3 is empty.
Creates forward motion, excitement.

QUARTER NOTE — 1/4 NOTE EARLY



Strongest anticipation. "And of 4" → beat 1 of next measure empty. Used: U2 "Beautiful Day"

ANTICIPATION HIERARCHY

Regular
1/8 note early
STRONG



Quarter Note
1/4 note early
★ **STRONGEST**



Both Together
layered groove
MAXIMUM GROOVE